

CIBA Website & Admin CMS — Hosting & Domain Handoff Guide

Audience: Person or agency that owns the **domain** and a **server** (or DNS access), and needs to put this site live on the real domain.

Prepared for: Central Interior Business Accelerator (CIBA)

Source code: <https://github.com/Rohitthimaya/ciba-site>

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1. What you are taking over

This project is **two websites** plus one shared database:

Piece	Purpose	Suggested live URL
Public website	Visitor-facing site (Home, About, Programs, Partners, News, TRU Generator)	<code>https://www.YOURDOMAIN.com</code>
Admin CMS	Staff login to edit news, events, people, FAQs, media, users	<code>https://admin.YOURDOMAIN.com</code>
Supabase	Database, login, and image storage (already set up)	Managed at <code>supabase.com</code>

Both apps are built with **Next.js** (Node.js). They are **not** plain HTML you can upload by FTP to shared hosting.

Current temporary live URLs (Vercel)

These already work. You can either **point the real domain at them**, or **move the apps onto your own server**.

App	Temporary URL
Public site	https://ciba-site.vercel.app
Admin CMS	https://ciba-admin.vercel.app

2. Choose one path (read this first)

Path	When to use	Effort
Path 1 — Keep Vercel, attach your domain	You have a domain (and maybe a server you don't want to use for this). Fastest.	Low
Path 2 — Run both apps on your own server	You have a Linux VPS/server and want everything under your hosting.	Medium
Path 3 — Other hosts (Netlify, etc.)	You already standardize on another Next.js-capable host.	Medium

Not supported: cPanel / PHP-only / FTP-only shared hosting. If that is all you have, use **Path 1** (domain DNS only) and leave the apps on Vercel.

Replace `YOURDOMAIN.com` everywhere below with the real domain (e.g. `acceleratebusiness.ca`).

3. Information pack (give / collect these)

3.1 From the developer (hand this over)

- ☐ GitHub repo access: <https://github.com/Rohitthimaya/ciba-site>
- ☐ This guide (PDF or `DEPLOY.md`)
- ☐ Supabase project invite **or** API keys (see below)
- ☐ Admin login email (super admin)
- ☐ Confirmation of temporary URLs above

3.2 Supabase API values (Project Settings → API)

Name	Used by	Secret?
Project URL (https://...supabase.co)	Public + Admin	No
anon public key (JWT)	Public + Admin	No (browser-safe)
service_role key (JWT)	Admin only	Yes — never share publicly

3.3 Environment variables

Public website

```
NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_URL=https://YOUR_PROJECT.supabase.co
NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY=YOUR_ANON_KEY
```

Admin CMS (all of the above, plus)

```
SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY=YOUR_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY
SUPER_ADMIN_EMAIL=you@YOURDOMAIN.com
NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL=https://www.YOURDOMAIN.com
```

`NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL` must be the **public** site URL, not the admin URL.

3.4 From the domain / server owner (fill in)

Item	Your value
Production public domain	https://www. _____
Production admin domain	https://admin. _____
DNS provider (where DNS is edited)	_____
Server type (if Path 2): Ubuntu / Debian / other	_____
Server public IP	_____
SSH access available?	Yes / No
Preferred path	Path 1 / Path 2 / Path 3

4. Path 1 — Keep Vercel apps, use your original domain (recommended if you only have domain + DNS)

This replaces `ciba-site.vercel.app` and `ciba-admin.vercel.app` with your real domain. The apps stay hosted on Vercel; you only change DNS.

4.1 Prerequisites

1. Access to the Vercel team/projects that own:
 - o `ciba-site` (public)
 - o `ciba-admin` (admin)
2. Access to DNS for `YOURDOMAIN.com` (wherever the domain is registered or managed).

If Vercel access must transfer: invite the new owner under Vercel → Team → Members, or transfer the projects.

4.2 Attach the public domain

1. Open Vercel → project `ciba-site` → **Settings** → **Domains**.
2. Add:
 - o `www.YOURDOMAIN.com`
 - o `YOURDOMAIN.com` (optional; redirect to `www`)
3. Vercel shows exact DNS records. Typical pattern:

Type	Host / Name	Value (confirm in Vercel UI)
A	@	76.76.21.21
CNAME	www	cname.vercel-dns.com

4. In your DNS panel, create those records. Remove conflicting old `A` / `CNAME` records for `@` and `www` .
5. Wait until Vercel shows the domain as **Valid** (minutes to a few hours).

Result: `https://www.YOURDOMAIN.com` serves the public site (same content as `ciba-site.vercel.app`).

4.3 Attach the admin domain

1. Vercel → project `ciba-admin` → **Settings** → **Domains**.
2. Add `admin.YOURDOMAIN.com` .
3. DNS:

Type	Host / Name	Value (confirm in Vercel UI)
CNAME	admin	cname.vercel-dns.com

4. Wait for Valid status.

Result: `https://admin.YOURDOMAIN.com` serves the CMS (same as `ciba-admin.vercel.app`).

4.4 Update environment variable for the public URL

In Vercel → `ciba-admin` → Settings → Environment Variables, set:

```
NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL=https://www.YOURDOMAIN.com
```

Redeploy the admin project after changing it.

4.5 Update Supabase Auth URLs (required for login on the new domain)

Supabase dashboard → **Authentication** → **URL Configuration**:

1. **Site URL**: `https://admin.YOURDOMAIN.com`
2. **Redirect URLs** — add:

```
https://admin.YOURDOMAIN.com/**
https://admin.YOURDOMAIN.com/auth/callback
https://ciba-admin.vercel.app/**
http://localhost:3002/**
```

Save. Then test login at `https://admin.YOURDOMAIN.com/login` .

4.6 Optional cleanup

- Keep the `*.vercel.app` URLs as backups, or remove them later.
- Change the admin password after handoff.
- Rotate `SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY` if it was shared earlier, then update Vercel admin env and redeploy.

5. Path 2 — Deploy on your own server + domain

Use this when you have a **Linux server** (VPS) with SSH and want to host both apps yourself.

5.1 Server requirements

- Ubuntu 22.04 / 24.04 (or similar)
- Public IPv4 (and IPv6 if you use it)
- Ports 80 and 443 open
- At least 1 GB RAM (2 GB preferred)
- Node.js **20+** (Node 22 or 24 recommended)
- Git
- A reverse proxy with HTTPS: **Caddy** (easiest) or Nginx + Certbot

5.2 DNS first (point domain at your server)

At your DNS provider:

Type	Name	Value
A	@	YOUR_SERVER_IP
A	www	YOUR_SERVER_IP
A	admin	YOUR_SERVER_IP

(Or use `AAAA` for IPv6.)

Wait until `ping www.YOURDOMAIN.com` and `ping admin.YOURDOMAIN.com` resolve to your server.

5.3 Install Node.js and tools (Ubuntu example)

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install -y git curl build-essential

# Node 22 via NodeSource (or use nvm)
curl -fsSL https://deb.nodesource.com/setup_22.x | sudo -E bash -
sudo apt install -y nodejs

node -v
npm -v
```

```
sudo npm install -g pm2
```

5.4 Clone the repository

```
sudo mkdir -p /var/www
sudo chown $USER:$USER /var/www
cd /var/www
git clone https://github.com/Rohitthimaya/ciba-site.git
cd ciba-site
```

(Use a deploy key or personal access token if the repo is private.)

5.5 Configure environment files

Public site — create `/var/www/ciba-site/.env.local` :

```
NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_URL=https://YOUR_PROJECT.supabase.co
NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY=YOUR_ANON_KEY
```

Admin — create `/var/www/ciba-site/admin/.env.local` :

```
NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_URL=https://YOUR_PROJECT.supabase.co
NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY=YOUR_ANON_KEY
SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY=YOUR_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY
SUPER_ADMIN_EMAIL=you@YOURDOMAIN.com
NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL=https://www.YOURDOMAIN.com
```

Protect secrets:

```
chmod 600 /var/www/ciba-site/.env.local /var/www/ciba-site/admin/.env.local
```

5.6 Build both apps

```
cd /var/www/ciba-site
npm install
npm run build

cd /var/www/ciba-site/admin
npm install
npm run build
```

5.7 Run with PM2

```
cd /var/www/ciba-site
pm2 start npm --name ciba-web -- start
# listens on port 3000

cd /var/www/ciba-site/admin
pm2 start npm --name ciba-admin -- start
```

```
# listens on port 3002

pm2 save
pm2 startup
# run the command PM2 prints so processes restart on reboot
```

Check:

```
pm2 status
curl -I http://127.0.0.1:3000
curl -I http://127.0.0.1:3002
```

5.8 HTTPS reverse proxy with Caddy (recommended)

Install Caddy, then `/etc/caddy/Caddyfile` :

```
www.YOURDOMAIN.com {
    reverse_proxy localhost:3000
}

YOURDOMAIN.com {
    redir https://www.YOURDOMAIN.com{uri} permanent
}

admin.YOURDOMAIN.com {
    reverse_proxy localhost:3002
}
```

```
sudo systemctl reload caddy
```

Caddy obtains Let's Encrypt certificates automatically.

5.9 HTTPS with Nginx + Certbot (alternative)

Example server blocks (HTTP first, then Certbot):

```
server {
    listen 80;
    server_name www.YOURDOMAIN.com YOURDOMAIN.com;
    location / {
        proxy_pass http://127.0.0.1:3000;
        proxy_http_version 1.1;
        proxy_set_header Host $host;
        proxy_set_header X-Forwarded-For $proxy_add_x_forwarded_for;
        proxy_set_header X-Forwarded-Proto $scheme;
    }
}

server {
    listen 80;
    server_name admin.YOURDOMAIN.com;
```

```
location / {
    proxy_pass http://127.0.0.1:3002;
    proxy_http_version 1.1;
    proxy_set_header Host $host;
    proxy_set_header X-Forwarded-For $proxy_add_x_forwarded_for;
    proxy_set_header X-Forwarded-Proto $scheme;
}
```

```
sudo certbot --nginx -d www.YOURDOMAIN.com -d YOURDOMAIN.com -d admin.YOURDOMAIN.com
```

5.10 Supabase Auth URLs (same as Path 1)

Set Site URL and Redirect URLs to `https://admin.YOURDOMAIN.com` (see section 4.5).

5.11 Updating the site later

```
cd /var/www/ciba-site
git pull
npm install
npm run build
cd admin && npm install && npm run build
pm2 restart ciba-web ciba-admin
```

6. Path 3 — Brief notes for other hosts

Netlify

- Create **two** sites from the same Git repo.
- Public site: base directory `/`
- Admin site: base directory `admin`
- Add the same env vars as above
- Attach `www` and `admin` custom domains in Netlify
- Complete Supabase Auth URL steps (4.5)

Cloudflare Pages / Workers

Only if your team already runs Next.js App Router there. Still need two projects, env vars, domains, and Supabase Auth URLs.

7. Admin login & roles

1. Open `https://admin.YOURDOMAIN.com/login`
2. Sign in with the super admin email/password provided at handoff
3. **Change the password immediately**

To create a new super admin in Supabase:

1. Authentication → Users → Add user
2. SQL:

```
update public.profiles
set role = 'super_admin', active = true, full_name = 'Your Name'
where email = 'you@YOURDOMAIN.com';
```

Roles: `super_admin` (users + everything), `editor` (content), `viewer` (read-only).

8. Supabase handoff

Keep existing project (usual)

1. Invite new owner in Supabase organization
2. Update Auth URLs for the real admin domain
3. Rotate `service_role` after handoff; update host env; redeploy
4. Reset admin password

New Supabase project (only if required)

1. Create project
 2. Run `supabase/ALL.sql` in SQL Editor
 3. Optionally: `node --env-file=admin/.env.local scripts/seed-news.mjs`
 4. Create super admin (section 7)
 5. Point both apps' env vars at the new project
-

9. Go-live verification checklist

Public — `https://www.YOURDOMAIN.com`

- ☐ Home loads (hero, news, partners)
- ☐ HTTPS padlock works
- ☐ `/news` shows articles and images
- ☐ `/tru-generator` calendar shows events
- ☐ `/tru-generator/resources` FAQs load
- ☐ `/about`, `/partners`, `/programs` load
- ☐ Contact / `mailto` uses a real email

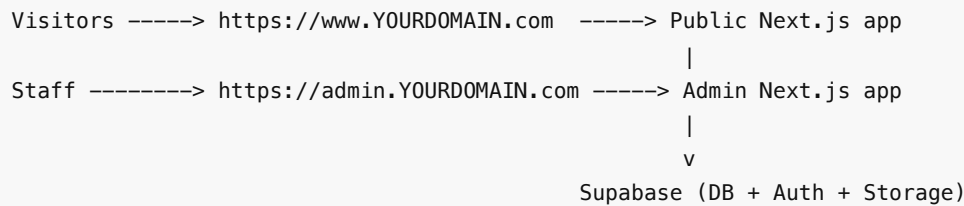
Admin — `https://admin.YOURDOMAIN.com`

- ☐ Login page loads
- ☐ Sign-in succeeds
- ☐ News / Events / Media open
- ☐ Edit a news post → appears on public site after refresh
- ☐ Media upload works

DNS / SSL

- ☐ `www` and `admin` resolve correctly
 - ☐ Apex domain redirects to `www` (if configured)
 - ☐ Old parking page / old host DNS removed
-

10. Architecture diagram



Hosting for the two Next.js apps can be:

- **Vercel** (Path 1 — domain only), or
- **Your server** (Path 2 — Node + Caddy/Nginx), or
- Another Next-capable host (Path 3).

11. Security reminders

1. Never commit `.env` / `.env.local`
2. Never put `SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY` on the public site
3. Rotate secrets after handoff if they were shared in chat/email
4. Use unique staff accounts in Admin → Users
5. Restrict SSH and keep the server patched (Path 2)

12. Quick decision guide

Situation	Do this
"We have the domain; we just want it live on www / admin"	Path 1 — attach domains in Vercel + DNS + Supabase Auth URLs
"We have our own Linux server and want to host it ourselves"	Path 2 — Node + PM2 + Caddy/Nginx + DNS to server IP
"We only have cPanel/FTP"	Use Path 1 (apps stay on Vercel; you only manage DNS)
"We use Netlify already"	Path 3

13. Support contacts / handoff notes

Role	Name	Email
Developer / build contact		
Domain / DNS contact		
Server admin		
Content / admin CMS users		

Chosen path: _____

Go-live target date: _____

Public URL: <https://www>._____

Admin URL: <https://admin>._____

End of guide. Full technical detail also lives in the repo as `DEPLOY.md`.